

9.6 Saving for Web - Slicing

Photoshop provides an excellent feature by which you can select different parts of an image to be saved with different compressions. The part of the image where you need detailing can be set to a lesser compression and the parts that are just background or unimportant can be set to a higher compression. Thus you will be able to strike a better balance between effective file size and quality of the image. This is done by ~slicing~ the image into different parts and applying a different compression (or quality setting). Another advantage is that each of the slices gets stored as a separate image and hence the user can see at least part of the composite image as it gets downloaded, rather than wait for the whole image to appear.

To make a slice, just click on the slice tool in the tool box and drag it across an area which you want to slice. Photoshop automatically creates other slices in the remaining parts of the image such that each slice is a rectangle. You can create any number of slices you like.

Now go to File > Save for Web. Just click on a slice to select it and choose the optimisation you require. You can choose from the presets available or set your own preferences that are available for each of the formats. Apply settings of your choice on each slice and click on ~Save~. Select to save as ~HTML with Images~. In your destination folder the html file and an image folder will be created. The HTML file will have the HTML tags to read and display images from the images folder that has been created. This html file can be put on your website. Anyone who accesses this file will be able to see the image that you have just optimised with slicing. The best use that this finds is when it is used in conjunction with HTML editing tools. A line of text can be so made into an image such that every word (made into a slice) links to a different location!